

Tech Mock — QA Engineering

Sep 28, 2026, 09:45 PM ET

[09:25 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Hi! I'm your AI interviewer for the Tech Mock — QA Engineering. This is a required interview for your career curriculum, and I'll ask you a set of questions one at a time. Take your time. Are you ready to begin?

[09:26 PM ET] You: Yes.

[09:26 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Great. Here's your first question.

Imagine you're testing a web page with a dynamically loaded list of items. How might you use a programming language, for example Python with Selenium, to verify that all expected items are present in the list after it loads?

[09:27 PM ET] You: Um, testing web page where a list of items loads dynami- dyna- dynamically, meaning the items might not appear immediately when the page opens. Uh, I would need to verify that once the list finishes loading, all the expected items are displayed correctly. I would use Python and Selenium and XSplit wait to wait for the list items to appear. Once they load, I would use Selenium to find all the items, get their texts, and store them in a list that would compare the actual items from the web page with my expected f- items from the test data. Uh, if all exceptitems are present, the test passes. If something is missing, the test fails and, and identifies which expect items would be found, wasn't found. This makes the automated test more reliable because it waits for the dynamic content before checking the results.

[09:27 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. You mentioned using an explicit wait to handle the dynamic loading. Can you walk me through what that wait condition might actually look like in code, and what specifically you'd be waiting for before making your assertions?

[09:28 PM ET] You: I'm testing webpage when the list loads dynamically so that the element m- might not be available immediately. Uh, before checking the items, I need to make sure Selenium waits until the list is actually loaded. Uh, I would use the web- WebDriver wait with an expected condition. For example, I'm telling Selenium to wait 10 seconds for the first element matching items to be presented after the condition is met. I can get the text from the elemental compare, the actual items w- with the, my expected items. Uh, this may... This makes the test more reliable because I'm not making any assertions before the dyna- dynamic content is loaded. It also avoids using fixed sleep, which c- can make the test unnecessarily slow or cause the failures with the page takes longer than expected to load.

[09:28 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Got it. Let's turn to the next question. I'd like you to talk through this code and explain what it is doing.

numbers equals a list containing one, two, three, four, five. Then a for loop: for number in numbers, if number modulo two equals zero, print that the number is even, otherwise print that the number is odd.

[09:29 PM ET] You: I'm looking at this simple Python program that has a list of numbers from one through five. Uh, the purpose of the code is to go through each number and determine whether it's even or odd. Uh, for the loop goes through each number one at a time, the condition is number percentage two equals zero. It uses, uses the module operator, which checks the remaining, remainder after dividing the number by two. If it remains e- remainder is zero, the number is even. Otherwise, the L statement identifies is as an odd. So thecode s-successfully checks every number in the list, identifies which each is even or odd.

[09:29 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. Can you tell me what the actual output would be when this code runs, line by line?

[09:30 PM ET] You: The code has lists containing the number one through five. Uh, it needs to check each number and determine whether it's even or odd. The loop process each number in order. It uses percentage two to check the remainder, uh, remi- remainder, and the remainder of zero means even. Otherwise, it is odd. So, one is odd, two is even, three is odd, four is even, five is odd.

[09:30 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Okay. Shifting gears a little — you've reported a bug, and the developer claims they cannot reproduce it. What steps would you take to work with the developer to resolve this discrepancy?

[09:31 PM ET] You: I report a bug during testing, but the developer told me they couldn't reproduce the same issue on their side, so I would need to determine why we were getting different results and give the developer enough information to reproduce the bug. I would re- re- reproduce the bug again on my side and review my steps, then I would compare our environments, including the browser's device, operating system, uh, and the application version. I would also provide screenshots, videos, error messages, and logs information. If the developer still couldn't reproduce it, I would work with them todirectly reproduce the issue together. Once we identified the differences, I would update the bug report with new information. After the issue was fixed, I would retest it to confirm the defect was resolved.

[09:31 PM ET] AI Interviewer: I see. You mentioned comparing environments as one of your steps. Can you give me a specific example of a time when an environment difference turned out to be the root cause of a discrepancy like that?

[09:32 PM ET] You: Uh, I haven't experienced the exact situation with the developer professionally yet, but during my Q&A training, I learned how environmental differences can cause the same features to behave differently. Uh, if I encountered this situation, my responsibility would be to identify exactly what different between my even- environment and development environment is. Uh, for example, if I reproduce a bug in Chrome, but the developer couldn't reproduce it, I would compare the browser versions, operating systems, and, uh, application builds. If we discover it was using a s- different Chrome version, I would teston both versions to confirm whether the browser version was actual causing the issue. Then I would document the information in the bug report, um, that I would give the developer the exact environments needed to reproduce and investigated the defect. It would also teach me to include detailed environment information in my bug reports from the beginning.

[09:32 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. Now, thinking about bug reports more broadly — you've found a critical bug during testing. Describe the key information you would include in your bug report to ensure it's clear, actionable, and gets resolved efficiently.

[09:33 PM ET] You: Testing, I, I discover a critical bug that could seriously affect the application and prevent users from co- completing an important function. My responsibility is to create a bug report that could give the developer enough information to understand, reproduce, and investigate the issue quickly. I would include a clear title, the environment where I found the bug, and preconditions and exact steps to reproduce it. I would document, uh, the expected results vers- versus the actual result, along with the severity and priority. I would also attach evidence such as screenshots, screen records, or error messages or logs. Because it's a critical bug, I would definitely communicate it to the team immediately instead of relying on the bug report. Uh, I would... A, uh, I, I... A detailed report to make it easier for the developer to reproduce and investigate the issue without having to come back to me for missing information, which can help the team address the critical, critical defect more than efficiently.

[09:33 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Got it. You mentioned severity and priority as two separate things. Can you explain the difference between those two, and how you would determine each one for a critical bug?

[09:34 PM ET] You: I found a critical bug and needed to determine b- both in severity or priority so the team understands its impact and urgency. I needed to evaluate how badly the defect affects, defect affects the system and how quickly it needs to be addressed. Severity describes the impact of the bug on the application. For example, if the application crashes or the users cannot complete a payment, I would never consider th- that a high or critical severity. Priority describes how urgent the bug should be fixed. If the payment issue affects customers in production or blocks release, it would likely need a high priority as well. Separately, s- separating se- f- severity and priority helps the team understand both how serious the effect is and how urgently it needs attention, which helps them make better decisions about what to fix first.

[09:34 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Okay. Let's turn to something a bit different. When testing a mobile banking application, what are some unique challenges or considerations you would face compared to testing a web-based banking application?

[09:36 PM ET] You: Um, testing a mobile app application where users are handling sensitive financial information, performing actions like log in, checking balances, transfer money, and making payments. Need to make sure that the banking features work correctly. We'll also consider challenges that are specific to mobile devices. I would test across different devices, screen sizes, and iOS and Android versions. I would definitely pay close attention to security, uh, including face ID and fingerprint and timeout sessions to make sure sensitive information isn't exposed. I will also test different network conditions such as switching between Wi-Fi and cellular data or losing the connection during money transfer. I will check interruptions like phone calls, background, backgrounding the app, and device's permissions. This would help assure the banking app is secure, reliable, and usable across different mobile environments, even when the user experience network changes or interruptions.

[09:36 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. You mentioned testing what happens during a money transfer when the connection drops. Can you walk me through specifically how you would test that scenario and what you'd be looking for?

[09:37 PM ET] You: I'm testing a mobile banking app while a user is transferring money. I want to see what happens if the internet connection is lost during the transaction. I need to verify the app handles the interruption safely and doesn't create an incorrect or duplicate transaction. I would start a money transfer, disconnect the network at different points, such as before submitting the transfer or immediately after pressing the transfer button. Then I would reconnect to the network and check the transaction status, account balance, and track transaction history. I will also verify that the app displays a clear message telling the user whether the transfer succeeds, fail, or is it still processing. I would make sure repeatedly tapping the button or reconnecting doesn't cause the same transfer to happen twice. The user should see an accurate transaction status, the account balance, that should be correct, and there should be duplicate transfer. If the app charged the account twice or show the incorrect status, I would report this as a serious defect.

[09:37 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Got it. Now, thinking about a different type of testing — consider a web form for user registration. Beyond valid input, what are some edge cases or negative test scenarios you would consider to ensure the form's reliability and security?

[09:38 PM ET] You: When testing a user registration form, I already verified that it works with normal, valid information. I need to make sure that the form also handles invalid, unexpected boundary inputs correctly and securely. I would test required fields left empty, invalid email formats, weak passwords, mismatched passwords, confirmation and duplicate usernames and emails, and input contained spaces or special characters. I would also test boundary values lip smack with the username and password exactly just below or above the allowed character limit. Uh, for security, I would test ex- unexpectedly or potentially malice input to make sure it handles safely. I also check repeated clicks on the submit button and what happens if the network connection drops during registration. lip smack These tests would help verify that the form rejects invalid data, provides clear error message, protects our user information, and remains stable when the users enters unexpected information.

[09:38 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. You touched on potentially malicious input as a security consideration. Can you give me a specific example of what that kind of input might look like and what you'd be checking for when you test it?

[09:39 PM ET] You: I'm testing a registration form and want to make sure the application safely handles potentially malice input instead of treating it as, as a command. I need to verify that the user input cannot be used, m- manipulate the database or expose sensitive information. For example, I could enter a basic, uh, SQL injection style test string such as OR 1=1 into a username field. Uh, I would check the application treats it as an ordinary invalid text rather than, um, execute it as, as a part of a database cor- uh, carrier. I wouldalso check the application doesn't expose database error-sensitive information or allow authorization, unauthorization access. lip smacks The application should safely reject or handle the input, display a appropriate validation message without crashing or exposing data. If the input affected the database or allowed authorization access, I would document it and report it as a serious security defect.

[09:40 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Okay. A new feature on a social media platform allows users to upload profile pictures. Beyond basic upload functionality, what specific test cases would you design to ensure its robustness and user experience?

[09:41 PM ET] You: I'm testing a new profile picture uploading feature on a social media. The basic upload works, but I need to make sure the feature is reliable and provides a good user's experience. I need to set different file types, sizes, images, conditions, and users' actions to make sure the feature, uh, handles both valid and invalid scenario correctly. I would test support formats like GPJ- JPG, PNG, as well as unsupported formats. I would test image at below and above the minimum file size limit, different images, dimensions, corrupted files, duplicate images, and filenames with spaces or sp-special characters. I will also check that the picture is cropped or displayed correctly without becoming stretched or blurry. After uploading, I verify that the new picture appears everywhere, and it should be such as the user's profile, posts, comments, and messages. I would also test replacing and removing the picture and check the feature on different devices on screen sizes. The test would be... would help ensure that the features handles unexpected files correctly, that users see clear, consistent, high-quality profile picture throughout the application.

[09:41 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. You mentioned testing corrupted files as one of your scenarios. What would you expect the application to do when a corrupted file is uploaded, and how would you verify that behavior?

[09:42 PM ET] You: I'm testing the profile picture upload feature and try to upload an image file that is corrupted or damaged. I need to verify the application handles the corrupted file safely instead of crashing or accepting an image it can't properly process. I will select the corrupted image and attempt to upload it. I will check the f- check the application, reject the file, and display clear error message, such as telling the user that the image cannot be processed or invalid. I will also verify that the previous profile picture remains unchanged, that the application continues working normally. The corrupted file should not be uploaded. The user should receive a clear message explaining the problem, and application should remain stable. If the app crashes, displayed or broken image, or replace the existing picture with an unusable file, I would report that as a defect.

[09:42 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Got it. Now, explain what an API is in simple terms, and why is it important for a QA engineer to have a basic understanding of APIs?

[09:43 PM ET] You: I'm testing an application that communicates with servers to send and receive information. As a QA engineer, I need to definitely understand how the communication works so I can test not only what the user sees or the screen, on the screen, but also what happens behind the application. In simple terms, an API is like a waiter in a restaurant. The application is the customer, the server is the kitchen, and the API is the waiter carrying the requests and responses between them. As a QA engineer, I can test API requests and responses, check the HTTP status codes, verify that the correct data is returned, and tests how the system handles invalid requests or errors. Understanding APIs helps me finding problems that may not be visible through the user interface and helps me test how different parts of the application communicates with each other.

[09:43 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. And finally, how can response codes help you troubleshoot issues in API testing?

[09:43 PM ET] You: Hmm. Can you repeat that question again?

[09:43 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Of course. How can response codes help you troubleshoot issues in API testing?

[09:44 PM ET] You: Um, testing API receives response that wasn't expected. I needed to understand where the problem might be coming from, whether it's related to my request authorization or endpoint as a server. I would look at the HTTP response code first. For example, 200 tells me the request was successful. 400 is indicating a problem with the request. 401 is, uh, indicated as an authorization problem. Uh, 404 can mean the response or endpoint wasn't found, or 500 indicates a server-side problem. Would review... I would, I would then review the request details and investigating further. Uh, response codes can give me a starting point for the troubleshooting, then help me narrow down the problem causing of the problem instead of guessing where the failed occurred.

[09:45 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. That brings us to the end of the interview. I appreciate the time and effort you put into your answers today. This interview is now complete and will be scored as part of your career programme. Best of luck!